C16W9 · TUESDAY, MARCH 24, 2026

# WELCOME BACK

Peer Review + The Rest of the Semester

**YOU'VE VALIDATED PROBLEMS AND BUILT MVPS.**

**NOW: WHAT DO I BUILD NEXT AND HOW DO I GET PEOPLE TO USE IT?**

# PEER PRODUCT REVIEW

Round 1

# HOW THIS WORKS

### 2 PEOPLE: HOST

- Stay at your station
- One person interacts with the tester, one takes notes
- **Your goal:** learn something new about your product
- Also note: what's working and what's hard about *this process*?

### 2 PEOPLE: TEST

- Go to your partner team's station
- Use their product cold, ask questions
- Give honest feedback
- Also note: what's working and what's hard about *giving feedback*?

💡 **Two 15-min rounds.** After Round 1, you'll rotate to a new partner team. No methodology on purpose — we'll teach structured methods later.

# ROUND 1 PAIRINGS SIMILAR PRODUCTS

### EXPERIENCE DISCOVERY
**Sift** (J-Combinator) ↔ **Vouch** (Basket Architects)
Finding NYC experiences vs. rating them

### SOCIAL THROUGH ACTIVITIES
**QuestCity** (Millionaires) ↔ **Rekindled** (LLMao)
Gamified social exploration vs. activity-based circles

### REAL-TIME COORDINATION
**Roam** ↔ **Circle** (The Birds)
Activity route matching vs. live hangout coordination

### SPORTS / ATHLETES
**FreeWeight** (team-frontend) ↔ **Recruitr** (Dream Team)
Training tools vs. athlete-coach recruitment

### PERSONAL AI TOOLS
**Misfit AI** ↔ **Evidence of Life** (August Fan Club)
Context-aware outfits vs. auto-timeline from calendar

### TRACKING + ANALYSIS
**NoticeMe** (4CUz) ↔ **Standard Deviants**
Screen time accountability vs. data analysis

Similar products paired intentionally. You'll learn the most from teams solving problems like yours.

# ROUND 1 IN PROGRESS

### PAIRINGS

- **Sift ↔ Vouch**
- **QuestCity ↔ Rekindled**
- **Roam ↔ Circle**
- **FreeWeight ↔ Recruitr**
- **Misfit AI ↔ Evidence of Life**
- **NoticeMe ↔ Standard Deviants**

### REMINDERS

- **Hosts:** 1 interacts, 1 takes notes
- **Testers:** use it cold, ask questions, give feedback
- **Goal:** learn something new about your product
- **Also:** note what's working and what's hard about this process

# ROUND 2 IN PROGRESS — SWITCH ROLES

### PAIRINGS

- **Sift ↔ Vouch**
- **QuestCity ↔ Rekindled**
- **Roam ↔ Circle**
- **FreeWeight ↔ Recruitr**
- **Misfit AI ↔ Evidence of Life**
- **NoticeMe ↔ Standard Deviants**

### REMINDERS

- **Hosts:** 1 interacts, 1 takes notes
- **Testers:** use it cold, ask questions, give feedback
- **Goal:** learn something new about your product
- **Also:** note what's working and what's hard about this process

# QUICK DEBRIEF

- What was **easy** to give feedback on?
- What was **hard**?
- Did you learn something about your **own** product by reviewing someone else's?

🧠 Hold these questions. We'll come back to structured feedback methods later in the semester.

# THE REST OF THE SEMESTER

# 9 CLASSES TO DEMO DAY

| 12 | 8 | May 12 |
|---|---|---|
| CLASSES REMAINING | WEEKS OF BUILDING | DEMO DAY |

I have a plan for the remaining weeks, but I want **your input** on what matters most to you right now.

# STARTUP TOPICS

## DISCOVER + DESIGN

- **Digital anthropology** — using Reddit, forums, and online communities to understand your users in the wild
- **AI design tools** — Canva, logos, clickable prototypes, prototyping vs. building

Understand your users deeper. Make your product look real.

## VALIDATE

- **User testing + feedback** — usability testing, onboarding flows, structured methods
- **Experiment design** — hypothesis, metric, sample, analysis
- **Pricing experimentation** — willingness to pay, unit economics

Test with real users. Sharpen your experiments.

## GROW

- **Social media + organic growth** — content, SEO, audience building
- **Lifecycle marketing + email** — retention loops, drip sequences

Acquire users AND keep them. A leaky bucket doesn't grow.

## MEASURE + PRIORITIZE

- **Analytics deep dive** — AARRR pirate metrics, GA / Amplitude
- **Feature prioritization** — what to build next, scoring frameworks, backlog management

Know your numbers. Then decide what matters most.

## PITCH

- **Pitch building + storytelling** — narrative, Demo Day prep
- **YC applications** — how to apply, what they look for
- **Fundraising + company formation** — seed rounds, equity, C-corps

Tell your story with data. Demo Day is May 12.

# AI TOPICS

### AI IN YOUR PRODUCT

When to add AI features vs. when it's unnecessary. Patterns that work: summarization, search, personalization, generation. Patterns that don't.

### AGENTIC DESIGN + ORCHESTRATION

Multi-step AI workflows, agent patterns, intro to frameworks like LangGraph. When to use a framework vs. roll your own.

### CLAUDE.MD VS SKILLS VS AGENTS

The layers of AI-assisted dev: project context files, reusable skill workflows, and autonomous agents. When to use which, how they compose.

### AI-ACCELERATED BUILDING

Going deeper than Week 7: better prompting for code gen, CLAUDE.md patterns, working with AI on complex features.

### RAG + RETRIEVAL PATTERNS

Making AI work with your data: vector DBs, chunking strategies, when RAG is the right tool.

### MCP (MODEL CONTEXT PROTOCOL)

Connecting AI to external tools and data sources. How MCPs work, when to use them, building your own.

# LET'S DISCUSS

- Which topics do you **need the most** right now?
- On the **AI side**: are you using AI in your product? Want to be? What's blocking you?
- On the **building side**: getting what you need from AI coding tools?
- Anything **NOT on this list** you wish we'd cover?
- How do you feel about **1-2 teams presenting each class** going forward?

📝 Your input shapes the rest of the semester. Speak up.

# THIS WEEK

# FOR THURSDAY DUE MAR 26

### ← LOOK BACK: PEER REVIEW

- What **worked** when people used your product?
- What **confused** them or broke?
- What's the **biggest gap**?
- Ship **one improvement** based on what you heard

### → LOOK FORWARD: YOUR ROADMAP

- What do you still need to **learn about your product**? (Who's your real audience? Is onboarding smooth? What makes the aha moment land?)
- What do you need to **build** between now and Demo Day?
- What's your team's **biggest open question**?
- What does **success look like** on May 12?

Submit to your team folder as `20260326/checkin.md`

💡 Reflect, ship, and plan. Due before class Thursday.

# TEAM PRESENTATIONS START MAR 31

### FORMAT

- **5-min demo** of your product
- **5-min Q&A** from the class
- 1-2 teams per class session

### WHY

- Practice reps before Demo Day
- Real feedback from the whole room

Sign up for a slot today. Every team presents before Demo Day.

# WHAT'S NEXT

- **Due Thursday** — Peer review learnings + product roadmap

You got real feedback today.

**Now go make your product better.**

# END OF CLASS 16

Next: Check-In + Topic Workshop (Mar 31)